Meaning as Binding

A Relational Ontology for Governed Semantic Systems

A relation may carry meaning without its existence, persistence, or exact anchoring making it legitimate or true.

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Abstract

This paper proposes an operational relational ontology in which meaning is not exhausted by intrinsic object properties or unconstrained mental projection but is constituted through bindings among interpreters, artifacts, references, practices, authorities, and contexts. A binding is a typed, scoped, temporally situated relation. Its existence does not establish truth, legitimacy, fidelity, or usefulness; those require separate evaluation.

The paper distinguishes four questions often collapsed in semantic systems: whether a binding exists, whether it is exactly anchored to a source, whether it is admissible under a declared regime, and whether it is a high-quality binding for a stated purpose. Meaning-inertia describes resistance to revision produced by dependency and reinforcement, but high inertia can indicate either legitimate structural integration or harmful lock-in. Binding quality is therefore multidimensional rather than a single universal score.

The current computational placement is the **Governed Meaning Base (GMB)**, following the author-confirmed lineage CCF -> CMB -> GMB. Exact-source overlays, semantic hashes, MCIR forms, receipts, and governed mutation can make bindings inspectable. They cannot manufacture semantic correctness merely by being present. In particular, verbatim overlay discipline proves textual anchoring, not entailment, interpretation quality, authority, or truth.

The result is a candidate ontology and evaluation program spanning philosophical meaning, governed knowledge, and constitutional computing. It remains subject to external literature comparison and empirical testing; the oscillatory and phase-coherence language is retained only as a provisional analogy unless a measurable model is supplied.

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1. Introduction

Philosophical debates concerning the nature of meaning have historically been framed as a tension between object-centered and mind-centered accounts.

Under **naive realism**, meaning is assumed to exist in objects themselves. Interpretation is therefore a process of discovering meaning already embedded in the world.

Under **naive idealism**, meaning is treated as a projection of mental activity. Objects possess no intrinsic meaning; interpretation assigns significance arbitrarily.

Despite their opposition, these positions share a common structural assumption: meaning must reside somewhere.

This paper rejects that assumption. Meaning does not exist as a property located in either objects or minds. Instead, meaning emerges from **relational binding acts** between structures.

Bindings are neither substances nor projections. They are structured relations that connect interpreters, artifacts, and domains of reference. When these relations stabilize, meaning appears.

This shift from location to relation reframes both philosophical and technical questions about meaning formation. Rather than asking where meaning resides, the relevant questions become:

- how bindings are formed,
- how they stabilize,
- how they propagate through systems,
- and how their quality can be evaluated.

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2. The Limits of Location-Based Theories

Location-based theories of meaning encounter complementary limitations.

2.1 Naive Realism

Naive realism assumes that meaning is intrinsic to objects. Interpretation merely reveals what is already present.

However, this view fails to account for the diversity of interpretations across contexts. Scientific paradigms, legal interpretations, and linguistic conventions demonstrate that meaning cannot be fully reduced to object properties.

2.2 Naive Idealism

Naive idealism treats meaning as mental projection. Interpretation becomes an act of assigning significance rather than discovering it.

This approach preserves interpretive flexibility but collapses constraints. If meaning arises entirely from projection, distinguishing coherent interpretations from arbitrary ones becomes difficult.

Both models therefore fail in opposite directions:

Model	Failure
Naive realism	ignores interpretive structure
Naive idealism	ignores objective constraint

A relational model resolves this tension.

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3. Meaning as Relational Binding

In the relational model proposed here, meaning arises through **binding acts** between structures.

A binding can be represented schematically as:

$$b = \mathrm{Bind}(x, y; r, \lambda, s, J, A, t, e)$$

Neither structure alone contains the meaning produced by the binding. The meaning exists in the stabilized relation between them.

Bindings possess several key properties:

- **Relational existence** – they do not exist independently of the structures they connect.
- **Stabilization** – repeated reinforcement can cause bindings to persist.
- **Composability** – bindings can participate in larger networks.
- **Inertia** – established bindings resist change because other structures depend on them.

Bindings therefore form networks that sustain semantic systems.

3.1 Typed Binding Model

A binding is not an unqualified edge. Let

$$b = (x, y, r, \lambda, s, J, A, t, e, p),$$

where x and y are the bound structures; r is relation type and direction; λ is the semantic lens; s is scope; J is jurisdiction or interpretive regime; A is claimed authority; t is valid and transaction time; e is evidence and provenance; and p is epistemic posture and standing. The same structures may support several non-equivalent bindings under different lenses or scopes.

For a declared context C, an operational meaning profile may be represented as the eligible binding neighborhood

$$M_C(x) = \{b \mid x \in b \wedge \text{Eligible}(b, C)\}.$$

This is not a claim that every form of human meaning reduces to a database edge set. It is a computational specification for making asserted semantic commitments inspectable. Absence from the represented neighborhood may indicate omission or representational limits rather than absence of meaning.

3.2 Existence, Anchor, Admissibility, and Quality

Four predicates must remain separate:

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{Exists}(b), \\ &\quad \text{Anchored}(b), \\ &\quad \text{Admissible}(b, C), \\ &\quad \text{Quality}(b, C) \end{aligned}.$$

An exact anchor can coexist with a false interpretation. An admissible binding can be low-value or later revised. A useful exploratory binding can remain inadmissible for consequential use. A persistent binding can be unjustified. The ontology becomes governable only when these differences survive representation and interface design.

4. Meaning-Inertia

Once bindings become embedded within networks of dependency, they acquire **meaning-inertia**.

Meaning-inertia describes the resistance of established bindings to change. This resistance arises from:

- institutional reinforcement,
- structural dependencies,
- shared conventions,
- and accumulated interpretive commitments.

Examples include:

- scientific theories,
- legal definitions,
- communication protocols,
- software interfaces.

In each case, the binding between structures becomes foundational. Altering the binding requires coordinated changes across dependent systems.

Meaning-inertia therefore explains why semantic structures persist even when new interpretations are possible.

4.1 Inertia Is Descriptive, Not Legitimating

For a perturbation class Δ and preservation constraints C, one provisional operationalization is

$$I(b \mid C, \Delta) = \inf_{\delta \in \Delta} \{\text{Cost}(\delta) : \delta \text{ removes or materially changes } b \text{ while preserving } C\}.$$

This definition makes inertia relative to what changes are allowed, what must be preserved, and how cost is measured. High inertia may reflect broad evidentiary support and legitimate dependency, or it may reflect institutional power, coordination burden, path dependence, monopoly, or accumulated error. Inertia predicts resistance; it does not confer truth or moral authority.

5. Technical Instantiation in Constitutional Computational Substrates

Relational binding is not merely a philosophical abstraction. It can be implemented technically within computational systems.

The current architecture is the **Governed Meaning Base (GMB)**, following the author-confirmed lineage Constitutional Crystallization Framework (CCF) -> Constitutional/Crystallized Meaning Base (CMB) -> GMB. The historical CCF formulation supplied the overlay example developed here; current synthesis treats that machinery as a historical profile within the evolving GMB lineage.

The historical formulation structures semantic artifacts through a two-layer model:

1. **Admitted source documents
2. **Overlays binding semantic cues to those sources

The crucial invariant is **verbatim overlay discipline**: each cue line within an overlay must be a verbatim substring of the source document.

This constraint ensures that an overlay cue has an exact textual anchor and prevents one class of source substitution. It does not ensure that the cue's classification, interpretation, authority, or downstream semantic commitment is correct. Those remain separately reviewable binding claims.

Meaning therefore arises in the binding relation:

$$b_s = \text{Bind}(\text{cue region}, \text{exact source region}; \text{verbatim-anchor})$$

Neither component alone contains the semantic claim expressed by the overlay. The claim emerges only through the relational structure connecting them.

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6. Verbatim Discipline as Ontological Constraint

The requirement that overlays contain verbatim substrings is not merely a formatting rule.

It enforces the relational ontology of meaning.

If overlays could introduce arbitrary text, meaning could be projected independently of the source. Conversely, if overlays were unnecessary, meaning would be assumed to reside entirely within the source.

Verbatim discipline prevents both errors.

The operational meaning claim exists in the typed relation among cue, exact source region, semantic lens, scope, and asserted interpretation. A verbatim violation is therefore a serious custody failure, but verbatim compliance alone is not semantic validation. The cue may quote exactly while misclassifying, decontextualizing, or over-authorizing the source.

For this reason, verbatim violations are structurally significant failures, while conforming overlays still require semantic, evidentiary, and authority review within GMB.

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7. Stratified Binding Structures

Within constitutional substrates, bindings do not exist at a single level.

Two categories of binding structures emerge:

- **Primitive bindings** – bindings admitted directly from authority sources.
- **Derived bindings** – bindings generated through derivation from primitives.

Derived bindings depend on explicit dependency structures. Each derived constraint includes a proof lineage identifying its originating primitives.

This stratification mirrors logical systems in which theorems derive from axioms.

It allows constitutional substrates to generate new constraints without expanding the trusted base of admitted sources.

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8. Oscillatory Binding and Phase Coherence

Bindings can also be interpreted through an oscillatory model.

Structures participating in a binding can be thought of as oscillatory systems. A successful binding occurs when these systems achieve **phase coherence**.

Phase coherence implies that the structural rhythms of the bound systems reinforce one another rather than interfere destructively.

Poor bindings produce phase drift, leading to semantic instability.

This oscillatory perspective explains why some bindings become powerful foundations while others collapse under pressure.

The oscillatory account is retained as a provisional explanatory analogy. No physical oscillator, measurable phase variable, coupling function, or empirical threshold is specified here. Accordingly, "phase coherence" should currently be read as a prompt to investigate mutual constraint, synchronization, and robustness across interacting structures–not as a demonstrated physical mechanism of meaning. The analogy should be removed or formalized if it does not generate discriminating predictions beyond the typed binding model.

9. Binding Quality

The relational ontology of meaning raises an important question: not all bindings are equally valuable.

Bindings vary along several dimensions:

9.1 Structural Coherence

A coherent binding integrates smoothly with existing semantic structures.

9.2 Generativity

Some bindings produce new structures and enable further reasoning or system construction.

9.3 Stability

Bindings that remain robust under perturbation possess greater durability.

9.4 Minimal Distortion

High-quality bindings preserve structural integrity across domains rather than introducing contradictions.

These criteria suggest the possibility of a future **theory of binding quality**, capable of evaluating semantic structures beyond their mere existence.

9.5 A Multidimensional Quality Profile

Binding quality should be represented first as a vector rather than collapsed into an unexplained scalar:

$$Q(b \mid C) = (F, S, A, C_o, L, R, G, V, D),$$

where F is source fidelity, S scope clarity, A authority validity, C_o constraint coherence, L lineage recoverability, R perturbation robustness, G generativity, V revisability, and D distortion or excluded-context cost. The dimensions may conflict. A binding can be robust but distorting, generative but weakly grounded, exact but unauthorized, or coherent only inside a narrow jurisdiction.

CM1 asks which binding configurations are admissible, including stable but harmful or low-value arrangements. CM2 applies declared preferences to distinguish desirable bindings from merely admissible ones. Any scalar score requires an explicit weighting function, jurisdiction, purpose, and sensitivity analysis. There is no context-free universal quality order in this paper.

9.6 Primitive, Derived, and Parasitic Bindings

"Primitive" identifies a declared authority or evidence root; it does not make the root infallible. A derived binding must preserve an inspectable derivation and cannot acquire more authority than its premises and derivation rule supply. A parasitic binding persists by exploiting dependencies, ambiguity, or asymmetric switching costs while contributing insufficient evidence or value. Because legitimate innovation may initially look weakly integrated, parasitism is a reviewable classification, not an automatic deletion rule.

10. Implications for Software Architecture

The relational ontology of meaning has direct implications for software systems.

Many contemporary development practices bind meaning at the level of **implementation artifacts** rather than at the level of domain specification.

This misplacement produces fragile systems that are difficult to compose or evolve.

Constitutional computational substrates relocate binding to the **specification layer**. Implementation becomes a derived artifact rather than the primary locus of semantic commitment.

This shift increases:

- interoperability,
- generativity,
- and structural stability.

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11. Implications for Knowledge Systems

Relational binding provides a unified framework for understanding diverse knowledge systems.

Scientific theories, legal systems, programming languages, and semantic networks all rely on stabilized bindings between structures.

By recognizing bindings as primary ontological elements, these systems can be designed to support:

- explicit binding formation,
- traceable binding lineage,
- and evaluation of binding quality.

11.1 Realization Funnel

- **Stage:** Possibility
  Meaning-as-binding responsibility: Preserve alternative ontologies, lenses, relation types, and counterexamples.
  Standing here: Open philosophical space.
- **Stage:** Specification
  Meaning-as-binding responsibility: Define typed bindings, contexts, identity layers, quality dimensions, source anchors, and limits.
  Standing here: Candidate specification.
- **Stage:** CM1
  Meaning-as-binding responsibility: Enumerate admissible binding configurations, including stable, harmful, parasitic, contradictory, or low-value cases.
  Standing here: Partially specified.
- **Stage:** CM2
  Meaning-as-binding responsibility: Apply declared preferences for fidelity, legitimacy, clarity, reversibility, pluralism, robustness, and low

distortion.
Standing here: Proposed quality profile.

- **Stage:** Instance Configuration
  Meaning-as-binding responsibility: Select ontology, schema, lens, jurisdiction, authority roots, evidence rules, weights, thresholds, time model, and revision policy.
  Standing here: Not selected here.
- **Stage:** Implementation Realization
  Meaning-as-binding responsibility: Encode bindings in GMB, MCIR, overlays, semantic hashes, receipts, and interfaces.
  Standing here: Examples only; conformance unproven.
- **Stage:** Evidence
  Meaning-as-binding responsibility: Test inter-reviewer agreement, source recovery, perturbation response, counterexamples, prediction, downstream performance, and revision.
  Standing here: Required and incomplete.
- **Stage:** Revision
  Meaning-as-binding responsibility: Amend bindings and quality judgments without erasing predecessor meanings, dissent, dependencies, or effects.
  Standing here: Required direction.

Compact Semantic-Binding Kernel

The completed P1 corpus positions Meaning as Binding as the **compact semantic-binding kernel**: meaning arises through typed, consequential, reidentifiable relations among relata under context and constraint. The paper supplies the minimal ontology; The Locus of Meaning supplies the extended theory of jurisdiction, recursive meta-binding, locus, and governance. Neither establishes that all relations are meaningful or that binding entails truth.

- **Adjacent work:** *The Locus of Meaning*
  Supplies: The extended relational-constitutional theory, semantic loci, jurisdictions, and consequences.
  Meaning-as-Binding boundary: Meaning as Binding remains the compact core rather than a duplicate full theory.
- **Adjacent work:** *Constitutional Binding Theory: Governed Anchor Resolution as a Universal Pattern in Semantic Systems*
  Supplies: A cross-layer anchor-resolution pattern.
  Meaning-as-Binding boundary: CBT generalizes governed resolution beyond semantic meaning; this paper defines the semantic ontology.
- **Adjacent work:** *Semantic Binding Quality (SBQ)*
  Supplies: A multidimensional profile for coherence, coverage, stability,

and fragility.
Meaning-as-Binding boundary: SBQ evaluates bindings; it does not define meaning identity or truth.

- **Adjacent work:** *Global Term Key: Constitutional Lexical Identity Through Disambiguated Semantic Binding*
Supplies: Registered lexical identity and resolver behavior.
Meaning-as-Binding boundary: GTK supplies address and disambiguation for bindings, not their entire meaning.

- **Adjacent work:** *Meta-Binding as Operational Invariant*
Supplies: Preservation obligations governing transformations of bindings.
Meaning-as-Binding boundary: Meta-binding protects binding commitments through change; it presupposes but does not replace the semantic kernel.

A minimal semantic binding is:

$$\begin{aligned} B = (&relata, roles, context, constraints,\\ &differential_sensitivity, uptake, consequences,.\\ &reidentification, provenance) \end{aligned}$$

Association becomes a semantic-binding candidate only when changes to the relation make a discriminable difference within a declared jurisdiction and the binding can be reidentified, used, contested, or revised. Persistence or popularity may create meaning-inertia without creating legitimacy, truth, authority, or quality.

The universal GSM can type `BOUND_WITH`, `PLAYS_ROLE_IN_BINDING`, `CONSTRAINED_IN_CONTEXT`, `DIFFERENTIALLY_SENSITIVE_TO`, `UPTAKEN_BY`, `HAS_SEMANTIC_CONSEQUENCE`, `REIDENTIFIED_AS_BINDING`, `PERSISTS_WITH_INERTIA`, `PARASITIC_ON_BINDING`, and `REVISED_BY`. These relations give the compact thesis operational edges while leaving thicker theory to adjacent works.

This integration establishes four editorial commitments: adopt compact semantic-binding kernel as the official corpus role; adopt the minimal binding record; require differential consequence and reidentifiability for semantic-binding claims; and explicitly route locus, jurisdiction, quality, lexical identity, and meta-binding to their companion works.

Binding Jurisdictions and Metaphor Firebreaks

The fixed-seed comparison with *The Phenomenal Aperture*, the consciousness-disambiguation protocol, the Jnana open-source projection, and *The Ableman Wheel* shows that "binding" must carry a declared jurisdiction. Descriptive, interpretive, operational, normative, institutional, and physical bindings may share a relational form without sharing evidence, mechanism, or consequence.

$$B_j = (relata, roles, jurisdiction, mechanism, authority, evidence, consequence, reidentification, revision)^{\cdot}$$

Phenomenal-frame binding concerns how presented relations shape human interpretation and action. Consciousness discourse requires a further mapping before that consequence says anything about phenomenality. Jnana uses operational and institutional binding when a specification, authority decision, capability, and realized effect constrain one another; semantic force alone does not authorize the project transformation.

The Ableman Wheel adjacency produces `NO_MATERIAL_RELATION` and a required metaphor firebreak. The paper's oscillatory and phase-coherence language cannot borrow physical standing, measurements, or mechanism from a proposed rotating apparatus. Conversely, a physical phase relation or residual would not validate the semantic-binding ontology. Shared words such as phase, coherence, field, or binding are retrieval leads, not derivation or evidence.

The universal GSM can type `BINDS_WITHIN_JURISDICTION`, `CARRIES_OPERATIONAL_CONSEQUENCE`, `REQUIRES_AUTHORITY_FOR_NORMATIVE_BINDING`, `MAPS_INTERPRETIVE_TO_PHENOMENAL_CLAIM`, `BLOCKS_METAPHOR_EVIDENCE_TRANSFER`, and `HAS_NO_MATERIAL_RELATION_TO_ABLEMAN_WHEEL_PHYSICS`.

This randomized review establishes four editorial commitments: add jurisdiction and mechanism to the minimal binding record; separate descriptive, interpretive, operational, normative, institutional, and physical binding claims; prohibit phase/coherence metaphor from borrowing physical evidence; and record no direct relation to the Ableman Wheel.

A Compact Relational Kernel with Jurisdictional Type Safety

Twenty retained downstream uses place Meaning as Binding across context compilation, admissibility, consciousness research, anchor resolution, collectives, meaning bases, possibility theory, epistemic orientation, compiler theory, lexical identity, governance compilation, controlled language, identity, open-source projection, meaning crystals, ontology change, qualia research, binding quality, semantic attractors, and semantic promotion. The stable core is a typed consequential relation, not a claim that every relation is semantic or legitimate.

$$B^* = (relata, roles, jurisdiction, context, constraints, \\ mechanism, differential_sensitivity, uptake, \\ consequences, reidentification, provenance, authority, \\ standing, quality, remainder, revision)$$

A relation is a semantic-binding candidate when a change to it makes a discriminable difference within a declared jurisdiction and it can be reidentified, used, contested, or revised. Existence, persistence, exact anchoring, salience, popularity, and inertia remain below truth, legitimacy, authority, quality, or beneficial consequence.

Descriptive, interpretive, operational, normative, institutional, phenomenal, and physical bindings require different evidence and mechanisms. Shared words such as field, phase, coherence, force, or binding are retrieval leads only. Translation among jurisdictions requires an explicit bridge, preserved distinctions, authorized loss, and remainder; metaphor cannot transfer proof.

The universal GSM can type
`BINDS_RELATA_WITH_ROLES`, `BINDS_WITHIN_JURISDICTION`,
`UPTAKEN_AS_BINDING`, `HAS_DIFFERENTIAL_CONSEQUENCE`, `REIDENTIFIES_BINDING`,
`PERSISTS_WITH_INERTIA`, `EVALUATED_BY_BINDING_QUALITY`,
`TRANSLATES_BINDING_WITH_REMAINDER`, and
`BLOCKS_METAPHOR_EVIDENCE_TRANSFER`.

This review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the complete jurisdictional binding record; require differential consequence, uptake, and reidentifiability; keep existence, inertia, legitimacy, truth, authority, and quality separate; and require typed bridges and metaphor firebreaks across binding jurisdictions.

11.2 Principal Failure and Counterevidence Conditions

The proposal is weakened if bindings add no explanatory or computational power beyond contextual representation; if the binary realism/idealism framing misstates relevant philosophical positions; if exact anchors systematically fail to improve interpretation; if quality dimensions cannot be measured or compared; if phase language produces no distinct predictions; if relational encoding suppresses embodied, pragmatic, affective, or tacit meaning; if graph structures create false precision; if inertia tracks power more strongly than evidentiary integration; or if simpler provenance and versioning mechanisms provide the same practical assurance.

These conditions do not automatically refute the relational thesis. They bound what the paper may claim and define the research needed to distinguish ontology, metaphor, data model, and implemented assurance.

A Relation Can Carry Meaning Without Becoming True or Legitimate

Public orientation

Meaning as Binding treats computationally representable meaning as a typed relation among relata, interpreters, contexts, jurisdictions, practices, authorities, evidence, and consequences. This avoids placing meaning wholly inside an object or wholly inside an unconstrained interpreter. The model is an operational relational ontology for governed semantic systems, not a claim that every human, embodied, phenomenal, or cultural form of meaning reduces to graph edges.

Adversarial tests

1. **Relation-inflation attack.** Every association, co-occurrence, dependency, or causal link is called meaning. A semantic-binding candidate needs declared roles, uptake, differential consequence, and reidentifiability.
2. **Graphification attack.** Encoding a binding in a graph creates false precision while tacit, embodied, affective, pragmatic, or contested dimensions disappear.
3. **Anchor-as-entailment attack.** Exact textual custody is treated as proof that an interpretation follows from, faithfully represents, or has authority from the source.
4. **Inertia-as-quality attack.** Persistence, popularity, institutional reinforcement, or dependency count is treated as truth or beneficial integration rather than possible lock-in and power.
5. **Quality-scalar attack.** Several jurisdiction-specific binding dimensions are collapsed into one universal score that hides tradeoffs and affected perspectives.
6. **Metaphor-transfer attack.** Phase, coherence, oscillation, force, or binding terminology transfers evidence from physics or consciousness research without a typed bridge.
7. **Philosophical-strawman attack.** Complex realist and idealist traditions are reduced to naive positions so the relational proposal appears to resolve the field.
8. **Authority-laundering attack.** GMB inclusion, semantic hash, MCIR encoding, receipt, or repeated use is treated as legitimacy, standing, or truth.

Claim and evidence ceiling

The paper proposes a typed relational kernel for asserted semantic commitments and a multidimensional binding-quality research program. It does not settle the philosophy of meaning, reduce all meaning to computation, establish phenomenal or physical mechanisms, validate a universal quality metric, or confer truth and legitimacy on recorded bindings.

Claims about philosophy, linguistics, cognition, phenomenology, physics, culture, software outcomes, or knowledge-system performance require external scholarship and domain-specific evidence. Oscillatory and phase-coherence language remains analogy unless a distinct measurable model and predictions are supplied. No external research was added in this pass.

Reader-facing consequence

The public benefit is an inspectable distinction: a system can show that a relation exists, where it is anchored, who treats it as operative, under which jurisdiction, with what consequences and evidence - while still leaving its truth, legitimacy, and quality open to contest.

12. Conclusion

The traditional opposition between object-centered and mind-centered theories of meaning rests on a mistaken assumption: that meaning must reside somewhere.

This paper proposes a relational ontology in which meaning emerges through **binding acts** between structures.

Bindings stabilize semantic relations, acquire inertia, and propagate through networks of dependency. When implemented within constitutional computational substrates, these bindings can be made explicit, traceable, and auditable.

Such systems demonstrate that philosophical claims about meaning need not remain abstract. Through careful architectural design, the relational nature of meaning can be encoded directly into computational infrastructure.

The next step in this research program is the development of a formal theory of **binding quality**, capable of distinguishing robust, generative bindings from fragile or parasitic ones.

Understanding these distinctions may prove essential not only for philosophical inquiry but also for the design of future knowledge and computational systems.

Realization Scope and Evidence Boundary

This successor makes the paper's stage boundary explicit. It narrows claims rather than manufacturing missing evidence: a stage named as context is not thereby claimed as implemented, validated, or complete.

- **Possibility Space.** The present paper does not claim a complete possibility space treatment. That stage remains successor work and cannot be inferred from the architecture described here.
- **Revision.** The present paper does not claim a complete revision treatment. That stage remains successor work and cannot be inferred from the architecture described here.

Corpus-Wide Reference Positioning

This paper argues that an operational relational ontology in which meaning is not exhausted by intrinsic object properties or unconstrained mental projection but is constituted through bindings among interpreters, artifacts, references, practices, authorities, and contexts. Its nearest external comparison fields are semantic, provenance, governance. The sources in [E1], [E2], [E3], [E4], [E5], [E6], [E7] are cited as predecessor literature, adjacent standards, or counter-pressure - not as evidence that they caused the Ableman framework or that they validate its novel claims. The comparison isolates where established work already supplies provenance, formal assurance, institutional constraint, empirical method, or engineering practice, and where this paper adds a distinct claim about admissibility, authority, semantic custody, or governed realization.

Within the Ableman corpus, the highest-priority current cross-links are [A1], [A2], [A3], [A4], [A5], [A6], [A7]. These are links among separately custodied works, not silent identity mergers. Their role is to expose mutual dependencies, terminology collisions, and places where a reader should traverse the corpus before treating this paper as self-sufficient.

Reference-pass counterevidence and limit search

The pass applied the following pressure tests: Formal vocabularies and graph links make commitments explicit but cannot by themselves establish correct identity, shared interpretation, or lossless translation between contexts. A complete provenance graph can faithfully record a false or unauthorized process; provenance is evidence about lineage, not automatic truth or legitimacy. A written constitution can legitimate domination as easily as constrain it unless amendment, participation, enforcement, and appeal remain effective in practice. These limits are not generic disclaimers: they identify the assumptions that a later empirical, formal, or implementation review must try to break.

Reference-pass influence and novelty boundary

No newly added external source is asserted to be a documented authorial influence unless the predecessor source already said so. `Predecessor` means earlier relevant work;

`adjacent` means a useful comparison; `standard` means an interoperability or assurance baseline; and `counterevidence` marks work that narrows or pressures a claim. Novelty therefore remains a reviewable, claim-level question rather than an inference from a low similarity score or an absent citation.

References

External scholarship, standards, and prior art

[**E1**] Richard Cyganiak, David Wood, and Markus Lanthaler, eds. *RDF 1.1 Concepts and Abstract Syntax*. W3C Recommendation, 25 February 2014. https://www.w3.org/TR/rdf11-concepts/ **Relationship:** Adjacent graph data model and identity baseline.

[**E2**] Alistair Miles and Sean Bechhofer, eds. *SKOS Simple Knowledge Organization System Reference*. W3C Recommendation, 18 August 2009. https://www.w3.org/TR/skos-reference **Relationship:** Adjacent standard for concepts, labels, schemes, notes, and semantic mappings.

[**E3**] W3C OWL Working Group. *OWL 2 Web Ontology Language Document Overview*, Second Edition. W3C Recommendation, 11 December 2012. https://www.w3.org/TR/owl2-overview/ **Relationship:** Adjacent formal ontology standard used to compare declared semantics and inference commitments.

[**E4**] Mark D. Wilkinson et al. "The FAIR Guiding Principles for Scientific Data Management and Stewardship." *Scientific Data* 3, 2016, 160018. DOI: 10.1038/sdata.2016.18. https://doi.org/10.1038/sdata.2016.18 **Relationship:** Predecessor stewardship principles for findability, accessibility, interoperability, and reuse.

[**E5**] Peter Gardenfors. *Conceptual Spaces: The Geometry of Thought*. MIT Press, 2000. mitpress.mit.edu source **Relationship:** Predecessor geometric treatment of concepts; cited as comparison, not as validation of the paper's manifold terminology.

[**E6**] W3C. *PROV-O: The PROV Ontology*. W3C Recommendation, 30 April 2013. https://www.w3.org/TR/prov-o/ **Relationship:** Adjacent provenance standard; it models entities, activities, and agents, but does not by itself establish the paper's stronger authority or standing claims.

[**E7**] Santiago Torres-Arias et al. "in-toto: Providing Farm-to-Table Guarantees for Bits and Bytes." *28th USENIX Security Symposium*, 2019, pp. 1393-1410. usenix.org source **Relationship:** Predecessor supply-chain lineage system used for comparison; no influence claim is made unless the source head already documents one.

Ableman corpus

[**A1**] Adam Ableman. *Governed Meaning Base (GMB)*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-D95CCC4FB7B58BFB`;
source SHA-256
`A3B62E50F8BEE125FDAE0D38C2839AFD1CCC138296268BF93217481E38AA48EA`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A2**] Adam Ableman. *Semantic Manifold Topology.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.20257244`;
source SHA-256
`B8F28CC652A73A3EE4CF6FD0E23C1ABC922A6660319B2FB4CC1CCAAA606EC64A`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A3**] Adam Ableman. *Global Term Key: Identity Primitives in Governed Knowledge Systems.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-358AC09F5A13587E`;
source SHA-256
`AFB29CFCB4B58A78B79709AD453CEE9088CCB2AE40F30A70260F1B54F5160579`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A4**] Adam Ableman. *Semantic Legitimacy Before Context.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-091E34BA93992CE4`;
source SHA-256
`DEB7626CE1AB54F4B541347DCC3C4E14DC4F682230ACCCE1A93D1D536A50C44C`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A5**] Adam Ableman. *Reasoning by Way of Receipts.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-04E427F6F4D94454`;
source SHA-256
`AF86A66CCD6A103DD75208500AE99148911A6453B6DFDF36A954279F21AB8489`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A6**] Adam Ableman. *The Epistemic Lineage Engine.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-E0EC3DC7EABF5060`;
source SHA-256
`CDD74D9AFAB6532645E68F7F6C9F0F7A9E472D9B8E717290522566FF8DC01F11`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A7**] Adam Ableman. *The Three Hash Rule.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.20788617`;
source SHA-256
`F6FA73D083B70711A8C817F7779751D1506FEBA0E356DB9805BB1570663731B5`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

Editorial source notes retained from predecessor

Adam Ableman. *Governed Semantic Compilation: Lawful Continuation, Refusal Semantics, and Epistemic Promotion in Large Language Models.* Zenodo, 2026. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18453681.

Adam Ableman. *Semantic Hashing: Hashes as Declared Equivalence Classes of Meaning.* Zenodo, 2026. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18500533.

Adam Ableman. *Semantic Custody.* Zenodo, 2026. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20300952.

Adam Ableman. *Semantic Crystallization.* Zenodo, 2026. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20310115.

Adam Ableman. *The Three Hash Rule.* Zenodo, 2026. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20788617.

Adam Ableman. *Governed Meaning Base (GMB).* Authorized Ableman Corpus edition developed through the historical CCF -> CMB -> GMB lineage; canonical concept standing remains governed separately from publication.

External comparisons to philosophy of language, pragmatics, semiotics, inferentialism, embodied cognition, scientific representation, legal interpretation, ontology engineering, and knowledge representation require a source-by-source literature review. This paper presently offers a formal proposal and internal corpus integration, not an independent novelty or empirical-validity finding.

The entries below are corpus-internal comparison and dependency sources. Their inclusion does not establish external validation of this paper's empirical, safety, novelty, or performance claims.

Adam Ableman *Constitutional Computation.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20624488

Adam Ableman *Governed Semantic Compilation: Lawful Continuation, Refusal Semantics, and Epistemic Promotion in Large Language Models.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.18453681

Adam Ableman *The Three Hash Rule.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20788617

Adam Ableman *Semantic Crystallization.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20310115

Adam Ableman *Semantic Custody.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20300952

Adam Ableman *Semantic Hashing: Hashes as Declared Equivalence Classes of Meaning.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.18500533

Adam Ableman *CARA: Constrained Artificial Reasoning Architecture.* Zenodo, 2025. doi:10.5281/zenodo.18099715

Adam Ableman *A Theory of Agentic Observation.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20437813

Corpus source and companion formats: https://github.com/AblemanMosaic/ableman-corpus
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DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.23848001